

Linux kernel team fixes a major security vulnerability



If you use a Linux distribution on your computer or an Android smartphone, you should apply the latest updates right away since the Linux kernel has been detected and patched with a serious security issue. The vulnerability, known as CVE-2022-0847 and dubbed ‘Dirty Pipe’, was identified earlier this year by Max Kellerman, a software developer at the Web hosting business IONOS.

Kellerman first became aware of the vulnerability in the Linux kernel since version 5.8 after getting customer complaints about corrupted files, according to a comprehensive blog post. He was able to recognise a pattern, and determine that the cause of the fault was in the Linux kernel itself after an identical problem occurred many times after the first report.

Kellerman notified the Linux kernel team the same day about his discovery, and the team swiftly issued a patch to fix the problem. All impacted Linux versions have received a security update, and Google’s Android operating system, which is based on a modified version of the Linux kernel and other open source software, has also been upgraded.

Dirty Pipe can be exploited by an attacker to acquire complete control over impacted computers and cell phones if it is left unpatched on susceptible systems. The attacker would be able to read users’ private chats, hack banking apps, and more with this access.

In general, Linux permits each file to have certain permissions for reading, writing, and executing it. An attacker was able to bypass these protection methods due to a flaw in the way memory is maintained for communication between various processes (through so-called pipes).

The Dirty Pipe flaw affects all Linux systems starting with kernel 5.8 and Android smartphones running untrusted apps. According to a recent email from IONOS, while untrusted apps are normally segregated from the operating system as much as possible, the problem might still be duplicated.

Karapace will have Instaclustr support

Database-as-a-service Instaclustr has announced that it will now support the open source Karapace schema registry technology, which was developed by its competitor Aiven. Aiven, situated in Helsinki, also offers database-as-a-service and supports a variety of database and data technologies. It offers managed Apache Kafka as one of its services.

Aiven released the open source Karapace project in 2020, which includes a schema registry for Kafka event streaming data and a REST interface. Instaclustr,

Meta releases open source browser extension for validating code

Code Verify is based on the concept of subresource integrity, in which browsers check the integrity of a fetched file. But it extends the concept to all resources on a website and uses Cloudflare as a trusted third party.

According to Meta, WhatsApp Web users can now utilise the plugin to confirm that the program has not been tampered with or altered. The plugin was created to automatically compare WhatsApp Web code to a cryptographic hash source of truth entrusted to Cloudflare, and to warn the user if any inconsistencies are discovered.

Cloudflare’s third-party verification, according to Meta, performs the tests automatically, in real-time, and at scale. Code Verify and the cryptographic hash source of truth on Cloudflare are updated whenever WhatsApp Web is updated.



Code Verify is now available for Chrome and Microsoft Edge, and will shortly be available for Firefox. According to Meta, users may rest assured that their privacy is protected because the extension logs no data or metadata, shares no information with WhatsApp, and has no access to user messages.

“In fact, neither WhatsApp nor Meta will know whether someone has downloaded the Code Verify extension. Additionally, the Code Verify extension never sends messages or chats between WhatsApp users to Cloudflare,” Meta said in a post.